

Biological weathering

This is when plants or animals cause rocks to break up. Plant roots often grow into small cracks in rocks, splitting them apart. An animal digging can also turn rocks into rubble.

Weathering

Weathering occurs when rocks are weakened, so that they crack and then break up into smaller pieces. This natural process can be caused by rainfall, changes in temperature, or even by plants as they grow. There are three types of weathering – biological, chemical, and physical.



Chemical weathering

Chemical reactions can break up rock. Acid rain, for example, destroys the stone in statues and buildings.



Physical weathering

Wind, water, and temperature changes weaken rock. If water in a crack freezes, it expands and can tear a rock apart.



WOW!

**Water erosion
created the
Grand Canyon in
North America!**